

Emma Donnelly

PhD Candidate · Agricultural Economics

Purdue University, 403 West State Street, West Lafayette, IN 47907

630-373-9305 — donnel26@purdue.edu

Education

Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN August 2023–Present

Ph.D. Agricultural Economics, Specialty: Resources, Environment, and Sustainable Production

Dissertation: Residential Sorting Equilibria and Floodplain Buyout Programs

Committee: Dr. Michael Delgado (chair), Dr. Carson Reeling, Dr. Maria Marshall, Dr. Richard Melstrom, Dr. Lala Ma

Loyola University of Chicago, Chicago, IL August 2022–May 2023

M.S. Environmental Science and Sustainability, 4+1 Program—Research Track

Master's Thesis: The Economic Value of Water Quality Improvements in Great Lakes Areas of Concern

Loyola University of Chicago, Chicago, IL August 2019–May 2022

B.A. Environmental Policy, Minor: Environmental Economics & Sustainability

Western Michigan University, Kalamazoo, MI September 2018–April 2019

Coursework towards B.S. in Environmental Sustainability Studies

Research Fields and Interests

Fields: Environmental and Resource Economics; Public Economics; Agricultural Economics

Research Interests: Climate Adaptation and Disaster Recovery; Housing and Residential Choice; Migration and Mobility; Community and Rural Development; Conservation; Nonmarket Valuation; Water Resources; Recreation Demand

Research Experience

Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN August 2025–Present

Agricultural Economics, Graduate Research Assistant, Advisor: Dr. Michael Delgado

Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN August 2023–August 2025

Agricultural Economics, Graduate Research Assistant, Advisor: Dr. Carson Reeling

Loyola University Chicago, Chicago, IL August 2021–May 2023

School of Environmental Sustainability, Graduate Research Assistant, Advisor: Dr. Richard Melstrom

Illinois Indiana Sea Grant, Chicago, IL June 2022–June 2023

Graduate Student Scholar & Primary Investigator, Administrative Lead: Dr. Lopamudra Chakraborti

Loyola University Chicago, Chicago, IL May 2021–August 2021

School of Environmental Sustainability, Undergraduate Researcher, Advisor: Dr. Reuben Keller

Publications

Donnelly, E. & Melstrom, R.T. (2026). The exchange value of ecosystem services from multi-site recreation. *Ecological Economics*, Volume 245, Article 108994. doi:10.1016/j.ecolecon.2026.108994

Donnelly, E., Melstrom, R. T., & Chakraborti, L. (2023). The economic benefits of remediation actions in the Waukegan harbor Area of Concern. *Water Resources and Economics*, 100236. doi:10.1016/j.wre.2023.100236

Donnelly, E. & Melstrom, R.T. (2023). Residential mobility and the value of water quality improvements in the Milwaukee Estuary Area of Concern. *Agricultural and Resource Economics Review*, 1-23. doi:10.1017/age.2023.10

Papers in Progress

Reeling, C.J., Melstrom, R.T., & Donnelly, E. Estimating Congestion Effects from Stated Preference Data. *Revise and Resubmit at the American Journal of Agricultural Economics*.

Donnelly, E., Reeling, C.J., Melstrom, R.T., & Phelps, A. Willingness to Pay for Sandhill Crane Hunting.

Donnelly, E. & Delgado, M.S. Property Value Impacts of Flood Buyouts: Checkerboard Effect, Flood Risk, and Green Space.

Donnelly, E. & Delgado, M.S. The Economic Effects of a Voluntary and Mandatory Flood Buyout Program: Evidence from an Equilibrium Sorting Model.

Fellowships, Honors, & Awards

- Travel Grant for Early Career Professionals and Graduate Students, AAEA Trust, Summer 2026
- Third Place Poster Competition Award, Purdue University Department of Agricultural Economics, Spring 2026
- Outstanding Master's Thesis Award, Northeastern Agricultural Resource Economics Association, Spring 2024
- Presidential Doctoral Excellence Award, Purdue University Dept. of Agricultural Economics, Fall 2023
- Student Paper Competition, First Place, Illinois Economics Association, Fall 2022
- Graduate Student Scholar, Illinois-Indiana Sea Grant, Spring 2022
- Summa Cum Laude, Loyola School of Environmental Sustainability, Spring 2022
- Loyola School of Environmental Sustainability Highest Honors, Spring 2022
- Ann Dunlap Scholarship for Environmental Law and Policy Research, School of Environmental Sustainability, Fall 2021
- Provost Fellowship for Undergraduate Research, Loyola School of Environmental Sustainability, Spring 2021

Grants

- **Residential Sorting Equilibria and Floodplain Buyout Programs**, \$8,500, Purdue University, Dr. Wally Tyner Doctoral Student Support Program grant, 2025–2027.
- **The Economic Benefits of Water Quality Improvements in Great Lakes Areas of Concern**, \$9,000, Primary Investigator with administrative leads Lopa Chakraborti and Max Melstrom, Illinois-Indiana Sea Grant, 2022–2023.

Presentations

- The Exchange Value of Ecosystem Services from Recreation, Applied Economics Association Conference, Kansas City, MO, July 2026.
- The Economic Effects of a Mandatory Flood Buyout Program: Evidence from an Equilibrium Sorting Model, Applied Economics Association Conference, Kansas City, MO, July 2026.

- Willingness to Pay for Sandhill Crane Hunting, Applied Economics Association Conference, Kansas City, MO, July 2026.
- Property Value Impacts of Flood Buyouts: Checkerboard Effect, Flood Risk, and Green Space, Midwest Economics Association Conference, Chicago, IL, March 2026.
- The Economic Effects of Flood Buyout Programs, Agricultural & Applied Economics Association Conference, Denver, CO, July 2025.
- Scope Testing in the Context of Rationed Goods, Midwest Economics Association Conference, Kansas City, MO, March 2025.
- Variation in Estimates of Willingness to Pay for Recreation Over Time, Midwest Economics Association Conference, Chicago, IL, March 2024.
- The Economic Benefits of Remediation Actions in the Waukegan Harbor Area of Concern, Illinois-Indiana Sea Grant funded research meeting, West Lafayette, IN, May 2023.
- Residential Mobility and the Value of Water Quality Improvements in the Milwaukee Estuary Area of Concern, Loyola Undergraduate Research Symposium, Chicago, IL, April 2023.
- Residential Mobility and the Value of Water Quality Improvements in the Milwaukee Estuary Area of Concern, Midwest Economics Association Conference, Cleveland, OH, March 2023.
- Residential Mobility and the Value of Water Quality Improvements in the Milwaukee Estuary Area of Concern, Southern Agricultural Economics Association Annual Meeting, Oklahoma City, OK, February 2023.
- Residential Mobility and the Value of Water Quality Improvements in the Milwaukee Estuary Area of Concern, Illinois Economics Association (IEA) Conference, Chicago, IL, November 2022.
- Improving Trapping Methods to Manage Invasive Crayfish in the Chicago Region, Loyola Undergraduate Research Symposium, Chicago, IL, April 2022.

Teaching Experience

Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN August 2026–December 2026
Teaching Assistant

- Advanced Quantitative Methods: Decision Making under Uncertainty (AGEC 685)
- The Macroeconomic, Trade and Policy Environment (AGEC 682)
- Strategy and AI in Society, Markets, and Decision Systems (AGEC 26100)

Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN August 2025–December 2025
Teaching Assistant

- The Macroeconomic, Trade and Policy Environment (AGEC 682)

Professional Experience

Environmental Law and Policy Center, Chicago, IL August 2021–May 2022
Policy Intern

Knoch Knolls Nature Center, Naperville, IL May 2019–August 2020
Environmental Education Intern